

Product Management Risk Checklist



VALUE

- ☐ Will it create value for the customers?
- ☐ Will customers keep using it?

USABILITY

- ☐ Will people figure out how to use it?
- ☐ Will people find it?
- ☐ Will it increase a cognitive load?
- ☐ Can we onboard them fast enough?

VIABILITY

- ☐ Works for different parts of the business?
- ☐ Can we sell it?
- ☐ Can we finance it?
- ☐ Can we monetize it?
- ☐ Is it worth the cost?
- ☐ Can we support our customers?
- ☐ Can we help our customers succeed?
- ☐ Can we scale it?
- ☐ Will it be compliant?
- ☐ What would it cost to scale AI?

FEASIBILITY

- ☐ Can we do it with the current technology?
- ☐ Is this integration possible?
- ☐ Can it be efficient?
- ☐ Can we scale it?

ETHICS

- ☐ Should we do it at all?
- ☐ Are there any ethical considerations?
- ☐ Will it pose a risk for our customers?

GO-TO-MARKET

- ☐ Can we market it?
- ☐ Do we have the required channels?
- ☐ Can we convince our customers to try it?
- ☐ Is this the right messaging for this channel?
- ☐ Is this the right time and way to launch it?

STRATEGY AND OBJECTIVES

- ☐ What needs to be true for our strategy to work?
- ☐ Can others copy our strategy?
- ☐ Have we considered political, economic, legal, technological, and environmental factors?
- ☐ Are those the best problems to solve?
- ☐ What our AI moat? Data? Distribution? Trust?
- ☐ How can we differentiate our AI? Workflow integration, UX, domain-specific context, community & ecosystem?

TEAM

- ☐ How well will the team work together?
- ☐ Do we have the right people?
- ☐ Do we have the right tools?
- ☐ Will the entire team stay with us long enough?
- ☐ What would happen if someone gets sick?

AI & AUTONOMY

- ☐ Will the AI behave as expected in real world?
- ☐ Can we control what actions it takes and what data it accesses?
- ☐ What happens if an external model or MCP server is compromised?
- ☐ Do we have monitoring and evaluation processes to track its performance over time?
- ☐ What are the guardrails or human-in-the-loop?
- ☐ Can we detect critical failures? How fast?



Make decisions informed by data and intuition



Prioritize two-way door decisions



Release early. No experiment is 100% conclusive.



Don't test everything; tackle high-risks



Place bets, 100% predictability = 0% innovation

